



SPRFMO

South Pacific Regional Fisheries Management Organisation

Jack Mackerel Working Group

Jack Mackerel MSE Task Team: 2026 Meeting Schedule and Agendas

Chair: J. Ianelli

Regular meeting time: 13:00-15:00 UTC

Meeting mode: Online, by Zoom or Teams unless otherwise specified

Purpose: Coordinate the technical path from benchmark outcomes to the June 2026 MSE workshop, SC14 documentation, and Commission decision-making.

Evaluation

This agenda is a useful working plan, but several items should be updated before circulation because the benchmark workshop has now occurred and because some dates in the source material are inconsistent.

Items to Resolve Before Circulation

- The source agenda lists the benchmark workshop as early or mid-May, whereas the benchmark meeting was held in Lima on 18-22 May 2026. References to the benchmark should be updated to the actual dates and outcomes.
- The Wageningen MSE workshop is listed as 15-19 June 2026 in the milestone table, while one agenda line refers to 16 June. Use a single date range in the final agenda.
- TT-04 and TT-05 should be revised to reflect the benchmark-derived model set, currently represented by model 0.11 in the assessment summary, rather than treating the benchmark handoff as unresolved background.
- The agenda should explicitly identify the decisions that are prerequisites for the MSE contractor: operating-model conditioning, recruitment-process assumptions, stock-hypothesis treatment, performance metrics, robustness scenarios, and exceptional-circumstances meta-rules.

Post-Benchmark Update Needed

The benchmark meeting moved the technical baseline from the SC13 configuration toward a materially updated assessment data configuration. The MSE agenda should therefore make clear which items are decisions for the Task Team, which are contractor implementation inputs, and which are remaining diagnostics or sensitivity analyses.

At-a-Glance Schedule

Regular meetings are the second Thursday of each month unless otherwise noted. Extra meetings are milestone-driven.

Meeting	Date	Topic	Key milestone
TT-01	Thu 26 Mar 2026	Post-Commission kickoff	Working-paper plan launched
TT-02	Thu 9 Apr 2026	WP1 launch and benchmark preparation	Leads to benchmark workshop
TT-03	Thu 30 Apr 2026	Final pre-benchmark preparation	Benchmark handoff checklist
TT-04	Thu 28 May 2026	Post-Lima / pre-intersessional debrief	MSE-02 draft performance metrics
TT-05	Thu 11 Jun 2026	Pre-Wageningen final preparation	Leads to Wageningen MSE workshop
TT-06	Thu 9 Jul 2026	Post-Wageningen: CMP shortlist review	SC14 paper drafting begins
TT-07	Thu 13 Aug 2026	Pre-SC14 draft review	Leads to SC14
TT-08	Fri 28 Aug 2026	Final SC14 paper sign-off	SC14 submission deadline
TT-09	Thu 8 Oct 2026	Post-SC14 debrief and Commission preparation	Leads to Commission decision
TT-10	Thu 12 Nov 2026	WP4 report review and year-end close	SC15 / archive

Programme Milestones

Month	Event	Deliverable	Output for
May 2026	Benchmark workshop, Lima, Peru	Candidate assessment models	SC intersessional
Late May 2026	SC intersessional meeting	Approved OM for MSE	Wageningen workshop
15-19 Jun 2026	MSE workshop, Wageningen, Netherlands	CMP shortlist	SC14 document
Sep 2026	SC14 Scientific Committee	CMP recommendation	Commission decision
Nov 2026	WP4 final deliverable	Technical report and source code	SC15 / archive

Detailed Task Team Agenda Plan

The detailed agenda below follows the source agenda structure for the first five Task Team meetings. Where consensus cannot be reached, decisions should be deferred by at most one session or assigned to a focused subgroup with a clear return date.

TT-01: Post-Commission Kickoff

Date: 26 March 2026, 13:00 UTC

Working papers: BM-01, BM-02, planning document

Discussion topics

- Review and endorse the working-paper plan for the benchmark, Wageningen MSE workshop, and SC14.
- Sequence and allocate technical topics across TT-02 to TT-05.
- Identify which decisions require a two-session process from preparation to conclusion.

Decisions

- Endorse the working-paper plan and confirm lead authors.
- Agree the TT-02 to TT-05 topic schedule that frames subsequent work.

Preparation

- Chair circulates BM-01 draft, BM-02 draft, working-paper plan, Carruthers MSE roadmap summary, and proposed topic allocation at least five working days before the meeting.

TT-02: Benchmark Preparation

Date: 9 April 2026, 13:00 UTC

Working papers: BM-01, BM-03

Discussion topics

- Selectivity alternatives, including block-based alternatives, time-varying selectivity, and fleet implications.
- Reference points, including fixed reference points versus dynamic ($B_{\{MSY\}}$) and ($F_{\{MSY\}}$).
- Stock-recruitment alternatives for initial reaction.
- Abundance indices, including inventory, CPUE standardization, and index-biomass proportionality.
- Uncertainty dimensions most consequential for long-term projections.

Decisions

- Narrow selectivity block options to no more than two candidates for conclusion at TT-03.
- Identify the preferred reference-point direction for conclusion at TT-03.
- Confirm BM-03 lead, scope, and index-standardization methodology.

Preparation

- BM-01 selectivity diagnostics, BM-03 outline, and updated topic schedule from TT-01.

TT-03: Final Pre-Benchmark Preparation

Date: 30 April 2026, 13:00 UTC

Working papers: BM-01, BM-03, BM-04

Discussion topics

- Conclude selectivity options for operating-model conditioning.
- Conclude fixed benchmark reference points and document the rationale.
- Far North treatment and consistency between the single-stock and two-stock hypotheses.
- OM grid design, including reference set versus robustness set and uncertainty axes in each tier.
- Define minimum benchmark outputs needed for TT-04 to proceed.

Decisions

- Agree selectivity block structure for OM conditioning.
- Agree fixed reference-point approach.
- Agree harmonized Far North treatment for both stock hypotheses.

- Agree OM grid structure and criteria for OM reconditioning.

Preparation

- BM-01 draft, BM-03 draft, BM-04 outline with OM grid sketch, and benchmark handoff checklist.

TT-04: Post-Lima / Pre-Intersessional Debrief

Date: 28 May 2026, 13:00 UTC

Working papers: BM-04, MSE-02, BM-01 outcomes

Discussion topics

- Benchmark debrief: model simplification, indices, OM design, agreed items, and unresolved items.
- Critical fork: recondition the OM on benchmark outputs or proceed with an SC13-based OM.
- Stock-hypothesis treatment for deriving advice.
- Performance metrics, including conservation, yield, and stability metrics.
- MP families, including model-free and model-based approaches.

Decisions

- Decide whether to recondition OMs on benchmark outputs or proceed with an SC13-based OM. This decision gates the Wageningen scope.
- Agree stock-recruitment priors and recruitment-regime treatment across OMs.
- Discuss stock-hypothesis treatment for advice, for conclusion at TT-05.
- Endorse draft performance metrics and time horizons for finalization at TT-05.

Post-benchmark update

The TT-04 agenda should now refer explicitly to the benchmark-derived model set, including model 0.11 as the current working final model in the assessment summary, and should identify which benchmark decisions are ready for OM conditioning.

TT-05: Pre-Wageningen Final Preparation

Date: 11 June 2026, 13:00 UTC

Working papers: MSE-01, MSE-02, MSE-03

Discussion topics

- Conclude stock-hypothesis treatment or confirm fallback treatment.
- Finalize performance metrics, time horizons, and risk tolerance for Wageningen.

- Freeze MP specifications, including data streams, tuning targets, harvest control rule, and buffer settings.
- Finalize robustness scenario matrix for the reference set and robustness set.
- Cross-platform validation between FLR and RTMB/OpenMSE.
- Wageningen trade-off format and decision-making protocol.

Decisions

- Conclude stock-hypothesis treatment.
- Finalize performance metrics, time horizons, and risk tolerance.
- Freeze MP specifications; no new MPs should be added after this Task Team meeting.
- Agree the complete robustness scenario matrix.
- Agree cross-platform validation protocol and assign responsibilities.
- Agree Wageningen communication and decision-making format.

Preparation

- Full drafts of MSE-01 and MSE-03, draft MSE-02 performance metrics, trade-off prototype if available, and updated OM status note from WMR.

Implementation Notes

- If the benchmark endorses OM reconditioning, TT-04 should be adjusted to incorporate benchmark outcomes before the Wageningen workshop.
- Stock-hypothesis weighting remains a potential sticking point. If no consensus is likely by TT-05, the Task Team should plan a focused subgroup call and define a fallback treatment.
- All working-paper drafts should be circulated at least five working days before each Task Team meeting.